

POLLINATOR WEEK 2026

“Life on a Leaf: Celebrating Caterpillars and Host Plants”

OFFICIAL EVENT REPORT

22 - 28 June 2026



GREENALAYA NEPAL



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Greenalaya Nepal is an organization working at the intersection of technology, research and conservation. It seeks to empower communities to conserve and restore ecosystems through data-driven tools, scientific evidence and collaborative action. The organization envisions communities where technology and research help protect ecosystems and build a resilient future.

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Glossary

Term	Meaning in this report
Biodiversity	The variety of living organisms, including diversity within species, between species and across ecosystems.
Citizen science	Anyone participating in scientific activities such as observing, recording, identifying or monitoring biodiversity.
Early life stages	Immature stages such as eggs, larvae and pupae.
Host plant	A plant used by an organism such as a caterpillar for feeding, development or reproduction, and butterflies for laying eggs.
iNaturalist	A biodiversity documentation platform where users submit observations with photographs, locations and dates.
Larva/caterpillar	The immature, feeding stage of a butterfly or moth before pupation.
Native plant	A plant occurring naturally in a region without being introduced there by people.
Observation	A record of a pollinator at a particular time and place.
Pollination	The transfer of pollen from anthers to a receptive part of a flower enabling fertilization in many plants.
Pollinator	An animal that transfers pollen between flowers intentionally or incidentally.
Pollinator habitat	A place that provides food, shelter, breeding resources, nesting sites or other conditions required by pollinators.
Research-grade observation	An iNaturalist status generally indicating that community identification and evidence meet the platform's criteria; it is not equivalent to a formal scientific specimen record.
Species richness	The number of different species recorded in a defined area or dataset.
Taxon/taxa	A named biological grouping, such as species, genus or family; taxa is the plural.

Executive Summary

Pollinator Week 2026 was organized from 22 to 28 June 2026 under the theme “Life on a Leaf: Celebrating Caterpillars and Host Plants.” Greenalaya Nepal coordinated the program in collaboration with conservation organizations, student associations, citizen-science groups and supporters. Two associated activities took place before the core week: a butterfly-watching and knowledge-sharing program on 6 June and a pre-week seminar on iNaturalist and biodiversity documentation on 21 June.

The program used a hybrid model combining expert-led virtual learning, field observation, in-person knowledge sharing, public social-media participation and structured citizen-science documentation. The approach was designed to make pollinator conservation accessible to students, naturalists, photographers, local residents, and conservation practitioners. This approach also tried to engage new observers and strengthen the capacity of all observers as citizen scientists contributing to biodiversity data-keeping.

The source report records more than 200 combined engagements across live sessions and field activities, nine collaborating organizations, eight participants completing the seven-day social-media challenge, and 14 participants qualifying for the Pollinator Marathon. It also reports more than 19,500 Facebook views during the relevant reporting period. These figures are one of the indicators of program’s effectiveness rather than impact measures.

The program generated several important outcomes: increased awareness of pollinator diversity and ecology; practical exposure to field observation and iNaturalist workflows; strengthened citizen science capacity; opportunities to learn from specialists in butterflies, birds and less-charismatic pollinators; new or documented biodiversity observations; and stronger relationships among organizations working on biodiversity conservation in Nepal.

At a glance

Pollinator Week 2026's greatest strength was its combination of accessible public education and action-oriented citizen science. Rather than treating awareness as an end in itself, the program encouraged participants to observe, photograph, identify, upload and discuss biodiversity records.

9	200+	8	14	9	19500+
Program Events	Total Attendance*	Challenge Finishers	iNaturalist Participants	Partner Organisations	Facebook Engagements

**Combined attendance across the five live sessions and field watch; does not include social media reach.*



Painted Jezebel butterfly (*Delias hyparete*) on the leaf of the *Liquidambar orientalis* tree in the Central Department of Botany, Tribhuvan University. ©Binit Timalsina



The pollinator bird known as the Green-tailed Sunbird (*Aethopyga nipalensis*) belonging to the family Nectariniidae in Phulchowki Hills (one of the IBAs of Nepal). ©Anish Maharjan

1 Introduction & Background

Pollinators include the four B's - Butterflies, Birds, Bees and Bats - alongside countless other species spanning arthropods to mammals. They transfer pollen between flowers, enabling fertilization and supporting the reproduction of many flowering plants. Their ecological importance extends beyond crop production: pollinators contribute to plant regeneration, food-web functioning, habitat maintenance and the persistence of plant–animal relationships. They reinforce ecosystem health and food security, yet remain chronically under-documented in Nepal in conservation planning and public discussion. Butterflies and bees may receive attention because they are visually appealing or familiar, while moths, flies, beetles and other pollinating organisms are less frequently documented. Likewise, the plants that support pollinators, especially native flowering plants and host plants used by caterpillars, are being overlooked in habitat-management decisions. Often described as the silent workers of the ecosystem, pollinators provide multiple benefits enjoyed both directly and indirectly.

Pollinator Week is an annual global observance that celebrates the importance of pollinators through locally organised events, raising awareness and educating communities on what pollinators are, why they matter, and how they can be conserved. This year's theme "Life on a Leaf: Celebrating Caterpillars and Host Plants" emphasizes the critical, often overlooked dependency of caterpillars on specific native host plants for survival and biodiversity. Pollinator conservation begins before an adult insect visits a flower. Caterpillars depend on particular host plants for food and development, and these relationships are essential to the continuation of butterfly and moth populations. Protecting pollinator habitat therefore requires attention to vegetation structure, native plants, seasonal resources, breeding sites, shelter and the broader ecological conditions that support early life stages.

For Nepal, the theme is especially relevant because the country contains substantial ecological variation across elevation, climate and habitat types. Urban forests, community forests, gardens, agricultural landscapes, protected areas and peri-urban green spaces can all support pollinator diversity. However, the distribution, seasonality and conservation status of many pollinator groups remain unevenly documented. Citizen science can help address this gap by enabling people to contribute standardized photographs and observations that may be reviewed, identified and reused for research and conservation.

Pollinator Week 2026 in Nepal formed a part of this global observance conceived as a practical learning and engagement platform. The event was designed to close local knowledge gaps by pairing scientific expertise with citizen science tools, giving trained naturalists and first-time observers alike a structured way to contribute verifiable biodiversity data. This year, Greenalaya Nepal initiated the program to help build recognition of pollinators' value among youth, local residents, and wider communities through a series of engaging events with contributors, supporters and local partners. The week built on strong momentum, bringing together a wide range of participants and previewing a collaborative model that stood out as one of the program's most encouraging outcomes. For a sustainable future of both human beings and pollinators, all forms of life and their habitats should be protected and conserved and it's our utmost duty.

2 Program at a Glance

The pollinator week knowledge sharing program combined online learning with hands-on field practice and public engagement events with different activities carried out.

Date	Events	Mentor/ Speaker	Participants
06 June	Pre-week Butterfly Watching and in-person knowledge-sharing program	Mahendra Singh Limbu (Coord. Siddhartha Sapkota and Shreejana Bajracharya)	45+
21 June	Pre-week seminar: iNaturalist for Biodiversity Documentation	Binat Timalina (hosts: Nabin & Siddhartha Sapkota)	35+
22 June	Pollinator Watching at Hetauda-Forestry Complex	IFSA Hetauda	18+
25 June	Virtual session: Butterflies as Pollinators	Arpana Khanal, Lepidopterist	25+
26 June	Virtual session: Birds as Pollinators	Carol Inskipp, Ornithologist	40+
27 June	Virtual session: Citizen Science for Non-Charismatic Pollinators	Dr. Anand Chaudhary, Ecologist	30+
28 June	Field Pollinator Watch, Ranibari Community Forest	Siddhartha Sapkota & Adhish Dulal (coord. Shreejana Bajracharya)	28+
22–28 June	“7 Days, 7 Colors, 7 Pollinators” social media challenge	Open to public	8 completed
22-28 June	Pollinator Marathon 2026	Open to public	14 qualified

Note: The source report uses “+” to indicate minimum or approximate participation. The figures should not be summed as unique individuals because the same person may have attended more than one activity.

3 Program Highlights

Nine collaborating organizations

The program brought together nine named partner or supporter organizations, creating a shared platform for conservation education, field observation, citizen science and outreach.

Hybrid learning model

The program connected virtual expert sessions with field-based observation and practical biodiversity documentation, allowing participation from different locations and backgrounds.

Seven-day public challenge

The “7 Days, 7 Colors, 7 Pollinators” challenge encouraged original pollinator photography, short educational facts and daily public participation.

Citizen-science participation

Fourteen participants were reported as qualifying for the Pollinator Marathon, while the iNaturalist seminar helped establish the technical foundation for biodiversity recording.

Field-based biodiversity learning

Godawari, Hetauda Forestry Complex and Ranibari Community Forest served as learning landscapes where participants could connect ecological concepts with real observations.

Public visibility

The source report records more than 19,500 Facebook views during the relevant period, with 63.9% attributed to non-followers. The precise platform metric should be confirmed before final publication.

4 Objectives and Approach

The program pursued the following objectives:

- Increase public understanding of pollinators and their ecological roles.
- Highlight the importance of caterpillars, host plants and habitat quality.
- Create opportunities for participants to learn from experienced naturalists and specialists.
- Promote responsible field observation and biodiversity documentation through iNaturalist.
- Encourage attention to less-charismatic and under-documented pollinator groups.
- Strengthen collaboration among conservation organizations, student groups and citizen scientists.
- Use digital communication to extend the reach of pollinator-conservation messages.

This program was initiated with the motive to create a common platform connecting people, nature and actions for conservation, research and awareness. It was based on 5 key activities, “LEDER” reflecting L- Learn, E- Explore, D- Document, E- Engage and R- Reflect (Figure 1). However, the implementation approach is little wider which includes,

- Knowledge sharing: expert-led talks and interactive discussions on butterflies, birds and citizen science.
- Field learning: guided observation in Godawari, Hetauda and Ranibari.
- Digital participation: a structured photography and fact-sharing challenge.
- Citizen science: observation submission through iNaturalist and the Himalayan Pollinator Patrol project.
- Networking: collaboration among organizations, facilitators, participants and conservation practitioners.
- Recognition: e-certificates, rewards and gift hampers for selected challenge and marathon participants.



Figure 1: LEDER mechanism of approaching and implementing the programs for effectiveness

5 Detailed Session Summaries

5.1 Pre-week Butterfly Watching and in-person knowledge sharing program (6 June)

Ahead of Pollinator Week, Greenalaya Nepal hosted a butterfly-watching program in Godawari on 6 June 2026, in collaboration with Butterfly Watchers Nepal, TinyLife Finders, and the Club for Wildlife Conservation (CWC). The event welcomed more than 45 participants for the butterfly watching and knowledge sharing program (Photograph 1). The event was led by Mr. Mahendra Singh Limbu who also serves as an advisor to Greenalaya Nepal. Mr. Limbu delivered an insightful presentation that equipped attendees with knowledge of butterfly ecology, behaviour, and field identification techniques. His guidance helped participants reflect on their sightings and deepen their understanding of the biodiversity they had encountered in Godawari's lush natural habitat. It was followed by an interactive question-and-answer session as well. Over 46 species of butterflies including rare and seldom-seen species like the Great Hockeystick Sailer and Scarce Lilacfork were also recorded during the butterfly watching program.



Photograph 1: Group Photos of Participants who joined and participated till the end of the butterfly watching at Godawari Forest Area along with Butterfly expert Mr. Mahendra Singh Limbu sharing some information on butterflies of Nepal with participants

45+ Participants	46+ Species Recorded	2 Rare Sightings
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5.2 Pre-Week Kickoff Seminar - iNaturalist for Biodiversity Documentation (21 June)

The program was hosted by Nabin Sapkota and Siddhartha Sapkota and the overall activities were presented by Mr. Binit Timalisina via Google Meet (Figure 2). He guided and inspired more than 35 participants for contributing as citizen scientists through iNaturalist workflows for recording, documenting and identifying plant and animal species using the iNaturalist application. Attendees were also introduced to Pollinator Marathon 2026 and encouraged to contribute observations through the Himalayan Pollinator Patrol and Butterfly Watchers Nepal citizen science projects, setting the data-collection foundation for the week ahead.

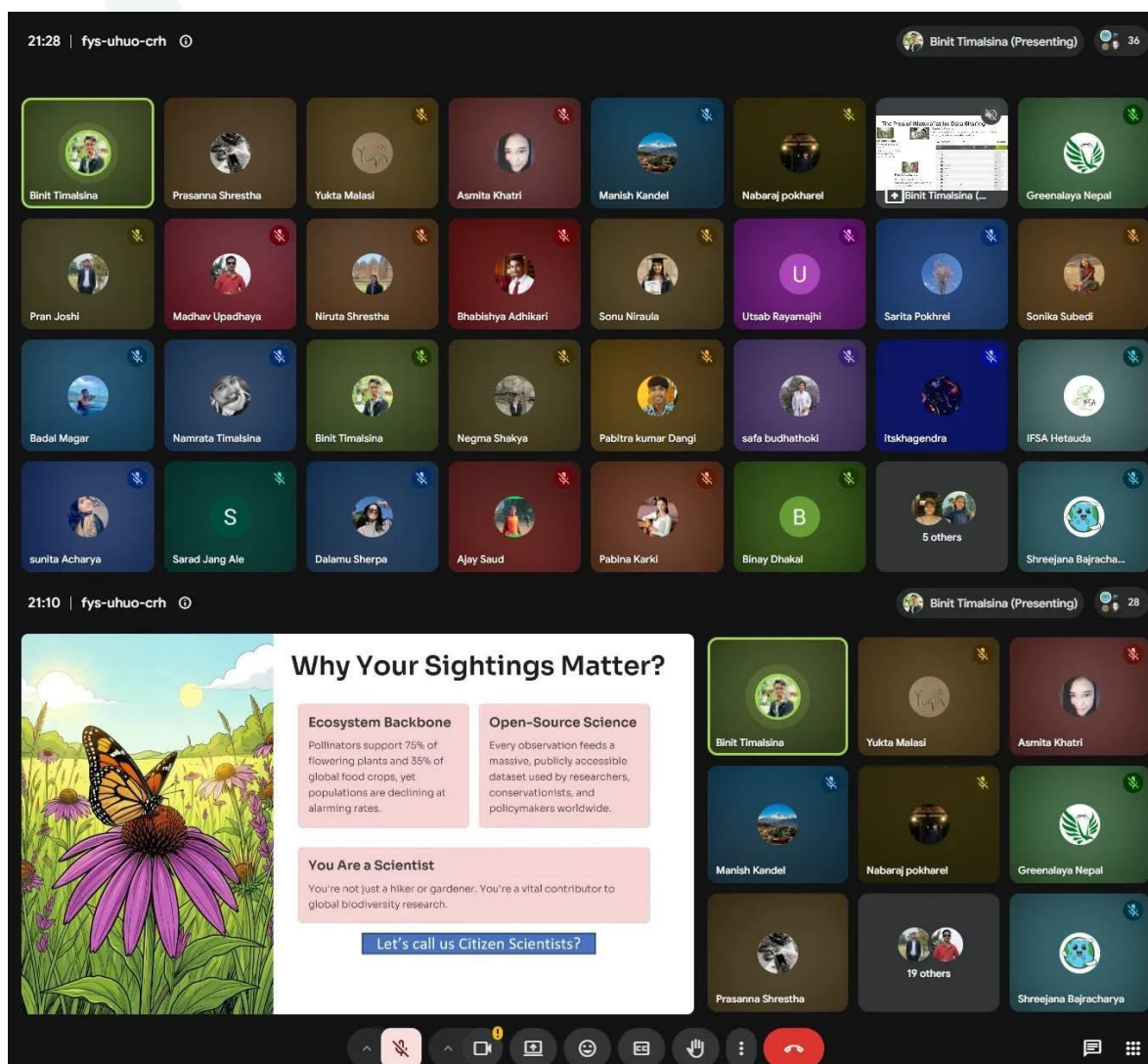


Figure 2: Online session where Mr. Binit Timalisina sharing why and how can we use iNaturalist and for what impact in various scenarios.

5.3 Pollinator Watching at Hetauda - Forestry Complex (22 June)

An inspiring start to Pollinator Week 2026 at the Forestry Complex, Hetauda where enthusiastic participation actively got involved. With about 18 participants, the exploration in the premises recorded more than 10 pollinator species which includes butterflies and bees. Thus, this contributed valuable observations for biodiversity conservation in the complex. Assistant Professor Prabin Poudel and Prof. Dr. Basudev Pokhrel shared their valuable insights and guidance on the fascinating world of pollinators and their ecological importance. This event was led by IFSA Hetauda (Photograph 2).



Photograph 2: Team from IFSA Hetauda who joined and contributed in the pollinator week where professors are guiding the observers.

5.4 Virtual session: Butterflies as Pollinators (25 June)

Young and dynamic early career conservationist and butterfly enthusiast Arpana Khanal led a session entitled “The behaviour of Butterflies: Understanding Survival, habits and Conservation in Nepal” for 25+ participants (Figure 3). She discussed butterfly morphology, threats facing Nepal's butterfly populations, and behavioural adaptations such as camouflage and mimicry. The session placed particular emphasis on:

- Nepal's conservation status: 142 butterfly species on the IUCN Red List, 27 endemic species, and 3 species listed under CITES Appendix II.
- A persistent research gap around early life stages (larvae and pupae) relative to adult butterflies.
- The role of native host plants in habitat restoration and long-term population recovery.

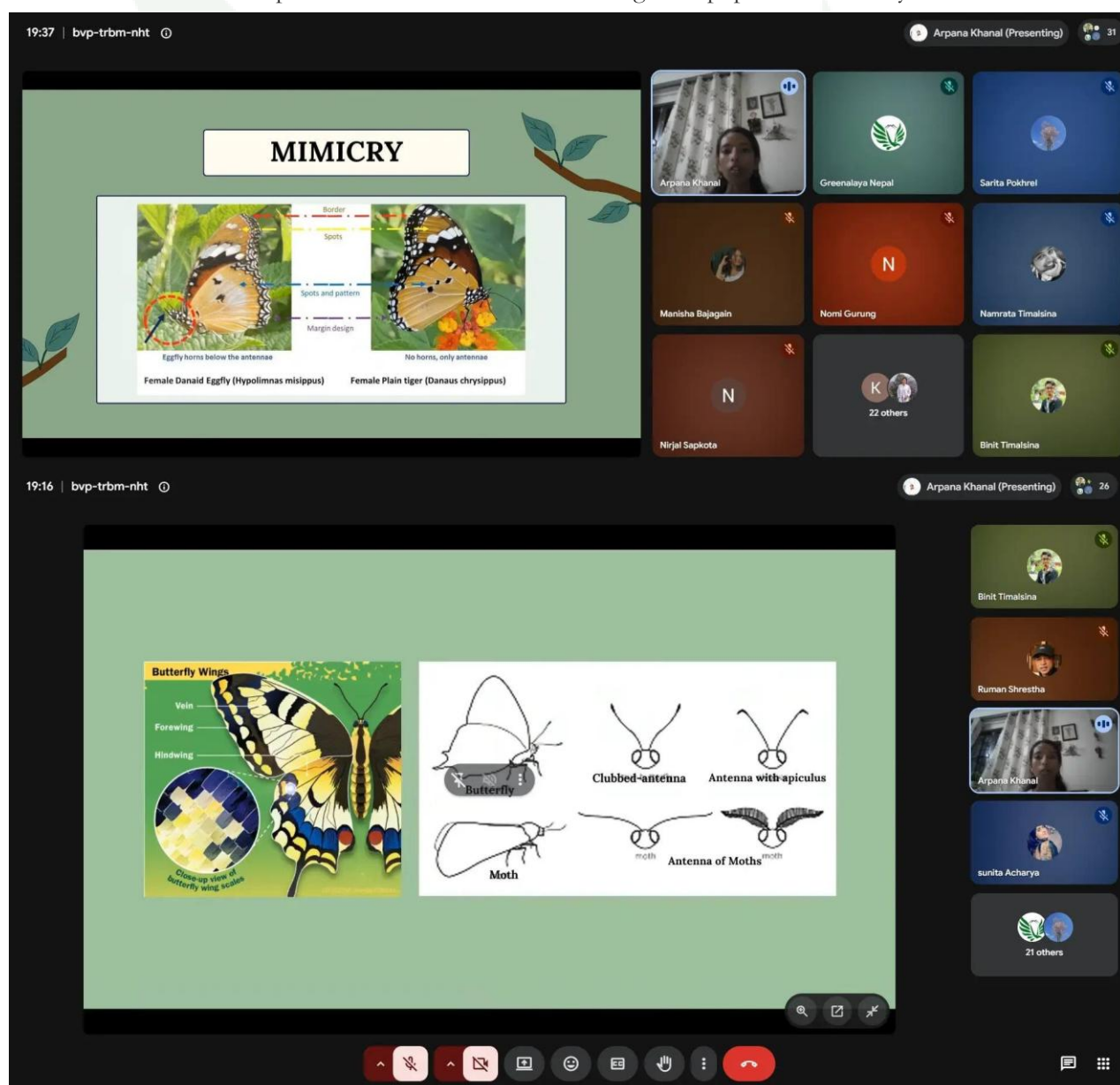


Figure 3: Ms. Arpana, a young conservationist and rising lepidopterist, sharing her experience and knowledge on the behaviour of Butterflies

5.5 Virtual session: Birds as Pollinators (26 June)

Renowned Ornithologist and conservationist Carol Inskipp drew the week's largest single-session entitled "Importance of Birds as Pollinators" where 40+ participants joined for a discussion of bird–flower co-evolution (Figure 4). Key points included the specialised tubular tongues of sunbirds adapted for nectar feeding, birds' ultraviolet colour vision and corresponding attraction to brightly coloured blooms, plant–pollinator specialism (certain flowering species relying on specific bird species), and the global decline of hummingbird populations. She also stressed that only 225 species of pollinator birds were remaining in the world which set off the urgency of pollinator-focused conservation.

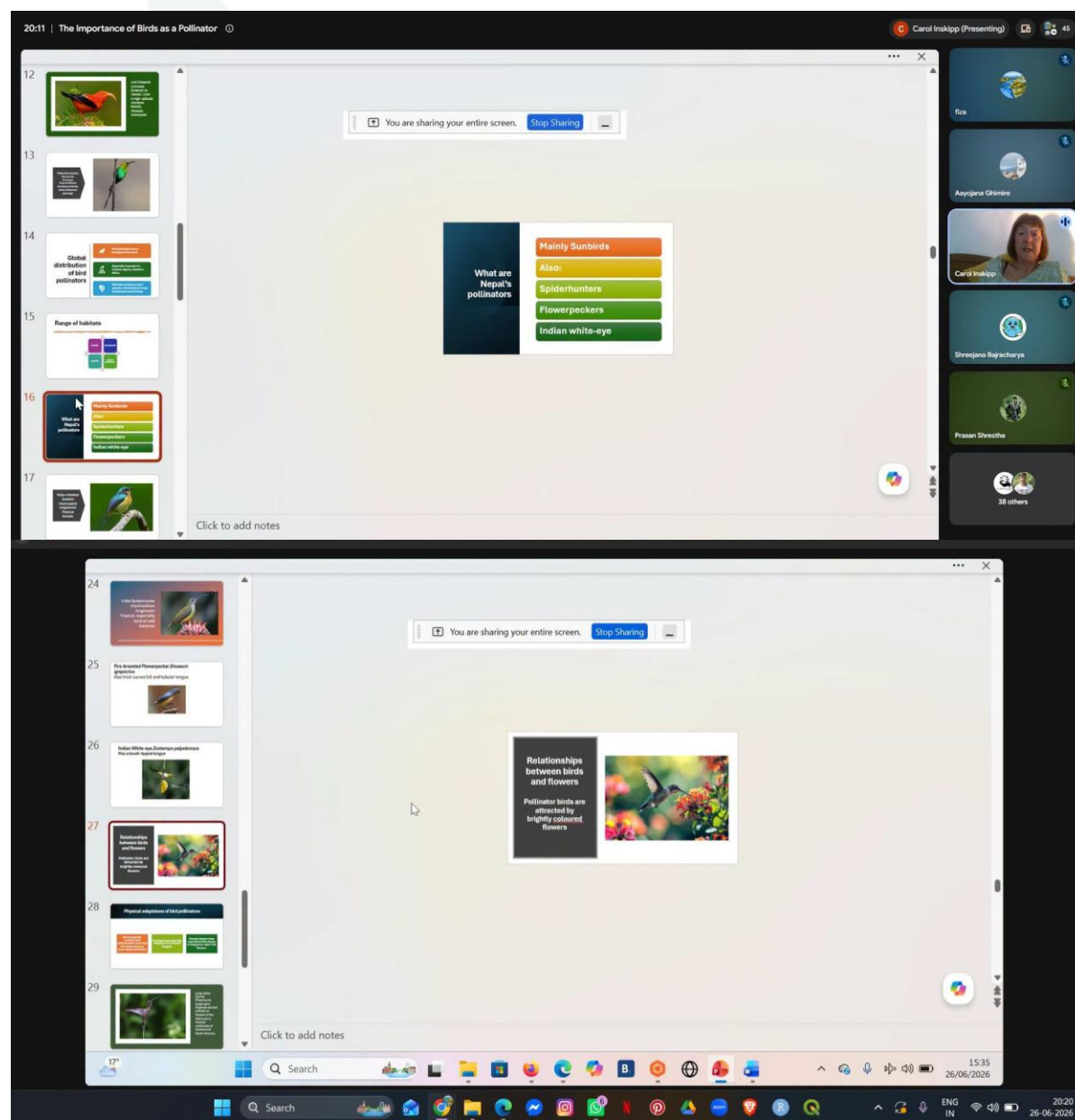


Figure 4: Ms. Carol Inskipp sharing her global and national context (in terms of Nepal) on pollinator birds and their status through online platform

5.6 Virtual session: Citizen Science for Non-Charismatic Pollinators (27 June)

Dr. Anand Chaudhary is an ecologist and serves as an official iNaturalist Ambassador in Nepal and he presented on “Documenting Nature for Conservation: Pollinators, iNaturalist, and Citizen Science” (Figure 5). This session moved beyond flagship species to equip 30+ participants with advanced iNaturalist techniques. The session encouraged many participants to record under-studied pollinators as well such as hoverflies, moths and native bees. This mechanism is not only used to celebrate similar conservation events but also to strengthen Nepal's baseline data for its least-documented pollinator taxa.

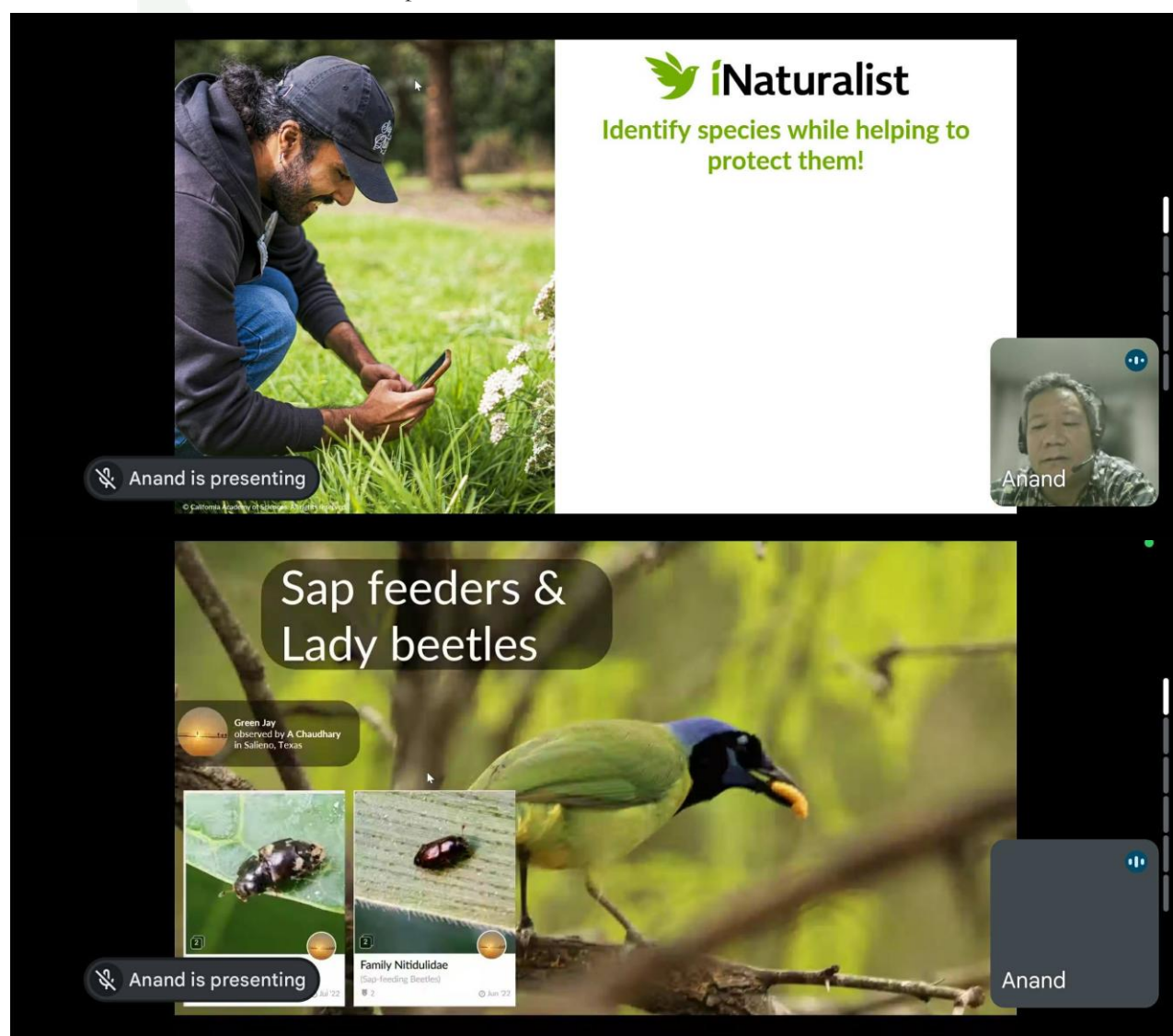


Figure 5: Dr. Anand Chaudhary introducing iNaturalist, its worldwide use, impacts on conservation and highlighting why we should participate

5.7 Field Pollinator Watch - Ranibari Community Forest (28 June)

The week's culminating field activity was led by Siddhartha Sapkota and Adhish Dulal which was coordinated by Shreejana Bajracharya. More than 28 participants were involved actively representing different organizations, young students, local people, conservationists, photographers and journalists as well. Ranibari Community Forest is a beautiful and isolated forest patch in the Kathmandu Valley and is home to numerous butterflies, hoverflies, moths, wild birds, and native bees (Photograph 3). Distribution of butterfly and bird conservation booklets was also done which was supported by Bird Conservation Nepal that includes photographs that help in identification and highlight conservation significance. Informal networking among conservation practitioners and citizen scientists was also a secondary benefit to the participants.



Photograph 3: Participants who joined the event at Ranibari Community Forest with group photo and activities of learning and sharing.

5.8 Digital Engagement - “7 Days, 7 Colors, 7 Pollinators” (22-28 June)

Running the full length of Pollinator Week, this public challenge invited participants to share original, self-captured photographs of pollinators matching a different daily colour theme. The 7 days were represented with 7 different colors where participants need to post matching pollinator photos accompanied by a short pollinator fact and tags the collaborators of the event. Only original field photography was accepted, and the photos should be posted between the 24 hours of the day for the adjacent theme. Eight participants, namely Asmita KC, Kohei Kosaka, Namrata Timalisina, Pushpa Raj Bhatta, Safa Budhathoki, Srijana Sharma, Yazu Nakarmi and Yukta Malasi completed all seven days and received e-certificates and additional rewards. More than 19,500 views were observed on Facebook with 63.9% were non-followers of Greenalaya Nepal (Figure 6).

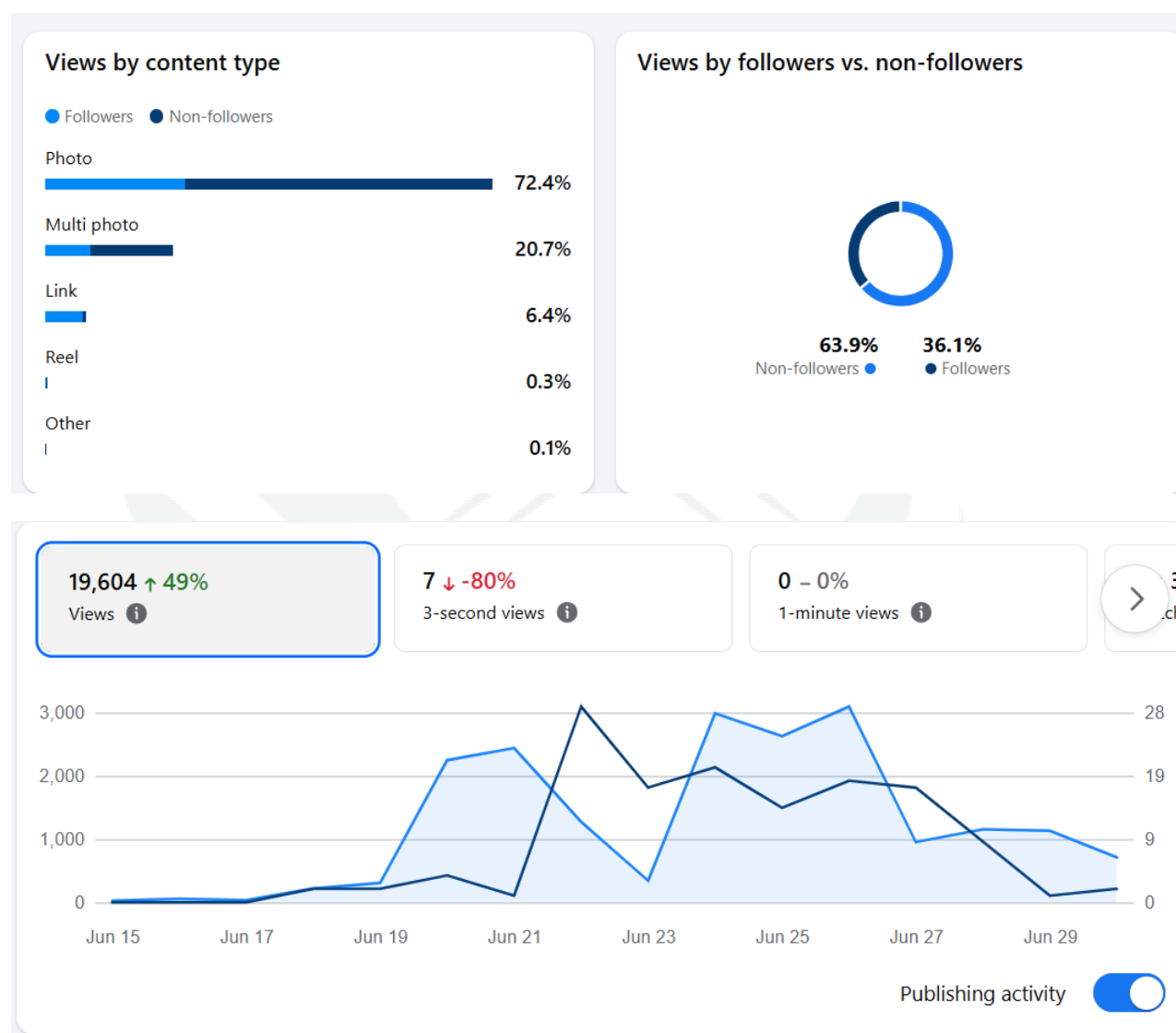


Figure 6: Metrics extracted from one of the social media platforms, Facebook showing different indices of engagement during the pollinator week

5.9 Pollinator Marathon 2026 - Himalayan Patrol Pollinator Project (iNaturalist; 22-28 June)

More than 14 iNaturalist Citizen Scientists were involved in this event where participants need to visit any of the places, explore any pollinators, capture their photographs and upload it to iNaturalist. All the participants followed the Himalayan Patrol Pollinator Project for being eligible in this marathon. The highest number of observations was recorded by Namrata Timalisina who observed 37 individual pollinators belonging to 18 species followed by Arpana Khanal observing 25 individual pollinators belonging to 21 species. The third place was held by Safa Budhathoki with 7 observations and 5 species of pollinators. They were awarded with e-certificates and gift hampers.

6 Partnerships and Contributions

Pollinator Week 2026 was implemented through collaboration and support from the following organizations and groups, as listed in the source report (Figure 7):

- Idea Wild
- Nature Conservation and Study Center (NCSC)
- Butterfly Watchers Nepal
- TinyLife Finders
- Club for Wildlife Conservation (CWC)
- International Forestry Students' Association (IFSA) Hetauda
- International Forestry Students' Association (IFSA) Pokhara
- Wildlife Conservation Society (CNRM) Katari
- Vision Green Organization

The partnership model distributed responsibilities across program design, facilitation, field coordination, outreach, participant mobilization, technical guidance, educational materials and knowledge sharing, citizen-science support, instrumental and gift hampers support, and recognition of participants.

Supported by



OUR COLLABORATORS
Pollinator Week Event 2026
 (June 22 - June 28)



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Greenalaya Nepal

NCSC

Nature Conservation & Study Centre



Butterfly Watchers Nepal



Club for Wildlife Conservation



Tinylife Finders



International Forestry Students' Association, Pokhara



Wildlife Conservation Society CNRM, Katari



International Forestry Students' Association, Hetauda



Vision Green Organization

Figure 7: Complete flyer of all collaborators and supporters of the Pollinator week 2026 event in Nepal

7 Outcomes and Emerging Impact

Outcome area	Evidence reported	Interpretation
Awareness and learning	Seven core/associated learning and field activities; specialist speakers	Participants gained exposure to pollinator ecology, behaviour, conservation and citizen science.
Participation	200+ combined reported engagements across live sessions and field activities	The program achieved broad direct participation, although unique-person counts are not available.
Citizen science	iNaturalist seminar; 14 Pollinator Marathon qualifiers	The program encouraged participants to turn learning into documented observations.
Public communication	Seven-day challenge; 19,500+ reported Facebook views	Digital outreach extended the program beyond physical and virtual attendees.
Networking	Nine collaborating organizations and cross-sector participation	The program strengthened relationships among conservation actors, students and citizen scientists.
Biodiversity documentation	Reported butterfly and pollinator observations from field activities	The program contributed observations, though completeness and verification depend on underlying records.

The program should not be described as a comprehensive biodiversity survey. Its principal impact was capacity building, public engagement, knowledge exchange and the generation or promotion of citizen-science observations. Longer-term impact would require follow-up tracking, repeated monitoring, data validation and evidence of changes in conservation practice.

8 Lessons Learned

Reflecting on the week's delivery, several insights emerged that will inform how future pollinator program are planned and run:

8.1 What Worked Well

- Hybrid formats increased accessibility: virtual sessions allowed participation across locations, while field activities provided practical context, network building, and in-hand/in-person learning with better field experiences.
- A clear theme improved coherence: the caterpillar and host-plant theme for 2026 (“Life on a Leaf: Celebrating Caterpillars and Host Plants”) offered a distinctive entry point into broader pollinator conservation.
- Citizen science approach strengthened: the iNaturalist seminar gave participants the basic technical guidance needed before, during and after submitting the observations.
- Supported and collaborated with different partners: the program benefited from shared networks, local partnerships, and different approaches to engaging and sharing knowledge among interested people.
- Recognition of participation and being on top-tier: e-certificates and rewards encouraged completion of the challenge, though these are most effective paired with learning and data-quality goals.

8.2 What We'd Do Differently

- Less-charismatic taxa needed deliberate promotion: a dedicated session on bats, moths and other under-recorded and unrecognized pollinators should have been conducted to help expand attention beyond visually popular pollinators.
- Standardize species and observation logging: a specific datasheet or application will be adopted for pollinator counts, tracking a complete environment-biodiversity-data picture next time.
- Close the gap between challenge sign-ups and completions: the number of participants engaged in field activities and virtual program was higher than the total number of participants accepting the challenges and completing them.
- Strengthened Collaboration: proper planning, roles and responsibilities distribution, organizing and concluding the different program and documenting every activity should have been done to reduce pressure and elevate the efficiency of the event.

9 Limitations and Data-Quality Considerations

Pollinator Week 2026 was designed primarily as an awareness, learning, field-observation and citizen-science initiative. It was not intended to function as a comprehensive biodiversity survey, population assessment or formal ecological monitoring program. The following considerations apply when interpreting the program results.

1. Program Scope and Coverage

- The findings represent program-specific observations rather than a national biodiversity assessment.
- Associated activities and partner-led events may have used different approaches and levels of documentation.

2. Observation, Taxonomic and Photographic Data Quality

- Observations were not collected through a standardized sampling design.
- Records were influenced by site accessibility, weather, flowering conditions, time of day and participant search effort.
- The number of observations should not be interpreted as a direct measure of pollinator abundance.
- Some organisms could not be identified confidently to species level. Identification accuracy may have been affected by image quality, viewing angle, lighting, distance and the availability of diagnostic features.

3. Interpretation of Biodiversity Records

- The records indicate observed biodiversity, not the total biodiversity present at a site.
- Pollinator–plant associations recorded during the program should be treated as observations rather than proof of ecological dependence unless specifically verified.

4. Participation, Baseline and Long-Term Monitoring

- Participation figures may include registered participants, actual attendees, unique participants, repeat participants, completed submissions and verified observations, which should be distinguished in future reporting.
- Online reach, views and interactions should also be reported separately using clearly defined metrics.
- As no systematic baseline or long-term monitoring framework was established, the results should be understood as immediate program outputs and preliminary observations.

5. Recommendations for Future Data Quality

Future editions could improve consistency and scientific value by:

- Using a standard observation method and reporting template to monitor and support long-term pollinator and habitat conditions.
- Documenting associated plant species and, where relevant, their relationships with different pollinator groups or life stages.
- Maintaining a centralized biodiversity database.
- Introducing short pre- and post-event learning assessments.
- Establishing repeat monitoring sites for longer-term comparison.

10 Conclusion

Pollinator Week 2026 brought together conservation organizations, professional conservationists, photographers, citizen scientists and the wider community around a shared goal: contributing to a better understanding of Nepal's pollinator diversity and ecology, including butterflies, pollinating birds and other pollinator groups. Through field activities, virtual learning, a public photography challenge and an iNaturalist marathon, the program connected awareness with active participation, generated new biodiversity records, expanded a growing local network of partner organizations/groups and strengthened conservation messaging across social media.

The program provides a useful foundation for future collaboration and citizen-science engagement. Its long-term value will be enhanced through improved data standards, clearly defined monitoring and participation metrics, repeated observations, systematic monitoring and continued collaboration among participating organizations.



11 Acknowledgements

Greenalaya Nepal expresses its sincere gratitude to all collaborators and supporters whose contributions helped make Pollinator Week 2026 possible. We gratefully acknowledge the support of Nature Conservation and Study Center (NCSC), Butterfly Watcher's Nepal, TinyLife Finders, Club for Wildlife Conservation (CWC), International Forestry Students' Association (IFSA) Hetauda, International Forestry Students' Association (IFSA) Pokhara, Wildlife Conservation Society (CNRM) Katari, Vision Green Organization and Idea Wild. Their support contributed to various components of the program, including participant engagement, pollinator observation and photography, biodiversity documentation and species identification, and the provision of gift hampers for the winners.

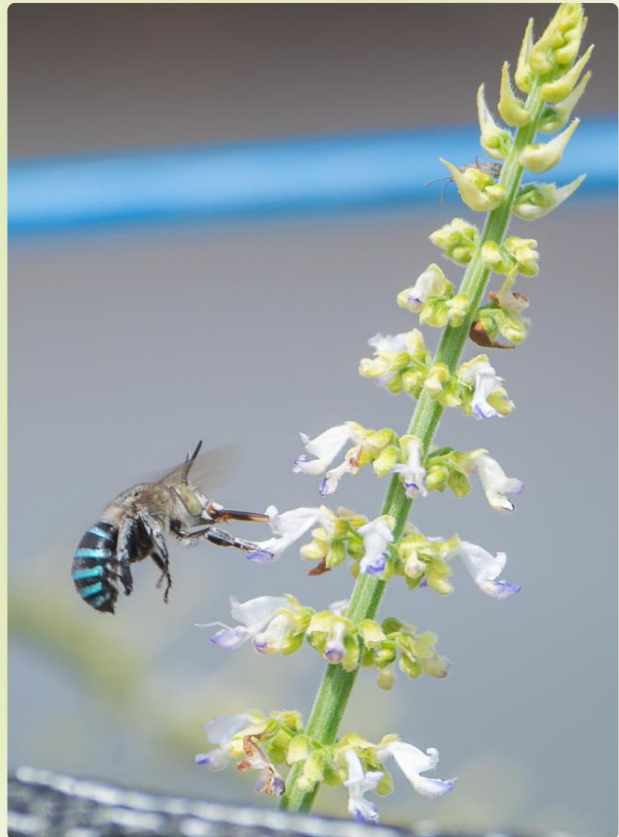
Special appreciation is extended to the presenters, activity leaders and experts, namely Mr. Binit Timalisina, Ms. Arpana Khanal, Dr. Anand Chaudhary, Mr. Mahendra Singh Limbu, Ms. Carol Inskipp, Mr. Adish Dulal and Mr. Siddhartha Sapkota for sharing their knowledge, expertise and guidance. We are particularly thankful to Ms. Shreejana Bajracharya for coordinating the event. We also acknowledge our advisors Mr. Mahendra Singh Limbhu, Mr. Ruman Shrestha and Mr. Prasan Shrestha for their continued support and guidance throughout the program. We thank Bird Conservation Nepal for providing leaflets and mini-books on the biodiversity of Ranibari Community Forest. These materials were valuable educational resources during the Ranibari pollinator-watching program and helped enrich participants' learning experience.

We extend our appreciation to all participants, photographers, observers, volunteers, winners, partner representatives and members of the organizing teams. Their time, effort, enthusiasm and willingness to share knowledge were central to the success of the program. We are also grateful to everyone who contributed educational materials, technical assistance, outreach, field guidance and rewards.

12 Looking Forward

- Develop an AI-assisted species-identification benchmark, initially focusing on pollinators, while maintaining expert review, transparent validation procedures and clearly stated limitations.
- Continue participation in citizen-science initiatives, including the Himalayan Pollinator Patrol and Butterfly Watchers Nepal projects, to support ongoing biodiversity documentation and learning.
- Expand access to field equipment, including binoculars, insect nets, field guides, macro-photography tools and basic data-recording materials, to improve the quality and accessibility of field observations.
- Develop standardized field forms and/or mobile applications to record attendance, observation effort, habitat characteristics, weather conditions, species records and photographic credits.
- Establish a follow-up monitoring plan to revisit selected sites and compare observations over time, while recognizing the limitations of differences in season, weather, observer effort and site conditions.
- Expand program on pollinator-related themes, including native host plants, pollinator-friendly gardening, pesticide awareness and habitat restoration.
- Engage and raise awareness among students and youths for pollinator conservation in various schools and local clubs in Nepal.
- Develop a public-facing dashboard or annual biodiversity summary based on verified observation data, with clear explanations of data coverage, verification status and limitations.

Strengthen coordination among partner organizations through a shared annual calendar, joint training activities and a common data-management protocol.



The playful activity captured of Blue banded bee in Colletes sp. plant species.

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13 Annexes

Annex 1. Core and associated program schedule

Date	Program component	Format / location
6 June 2026	Butterfly watching and knowledge sharing	In-person; Godawari
21 June 2026	iNaturalist for Biodiversity Documentation	Virtual; Google Meet
22 June 2026	Pollinator watching	In-person; Hetauda Forestry Complex
22–28 June 2026	7 Days, 7 Colors, 7 Pollinators	Digital / social media
22–28 June 2026	Pollinator Marathon 2026	iNaturalist / Himalayan Pollinator Patrol
25 June 2026	Butterflies as Pollinators	Virtual
26 June 2026	Birds as Pollinators	Virtual
27 June 2026	Citizen Science for Non-charismatic Pollinators	Virtual
28 June 2026	Field Pollinator Watch	In-person; Ranibari Community Forest

Annex 2. Social media challenge completion list

- Asmita KC
- Kohei Kosaka
- Namrata Timalisina
- Pushpa Raj Bhatta
- Safa Budhathoki
- Srijana Sharma
- Yazu Nakarmi
- Yukta Malasi

Annex 3. iNaturalist Marathon Winners

- **First Position:** Namrata Timalisina
- **Second Position:** Arpana Khanal
- **Third Position:** Safa Budhathoki

Annex 3. List of Pollinators Observed in Ranibari Community Forest

S.N.	Types	Common English Name	S.N.	Types	Common English Name
1.	Butterflies	Chocolate Pansy	12.	Butterflies	Lilacine Bush Brown
2.		Colon Swift	13.		Psyche
3.		Common Castor	14.		Restricted Demon
4.		Common Jester	15.		Spangle
5.		Common Mormon	16.		Straight-Banded Tree Brown
6.		Common Palm Fly	17.		Tailed Jay
7.		Common Sailor	18.		Yellow-Spotted Swift
8.		Dark Evening Brown	19.	Moth	Handmaiden Moth
9.		Dart Sp.	20.	Bees	Bumble Bee
10.		Great Mormon	21.	Birds	Blue-throated Barbet
11.		Indian Cabbage White	22.	Other Flies	Hooverflies

Annex 4. List of Butterflies Observed in Godawari Forest

S.N.	Common English Name	S.N.	Common English Name
1	Scarce Lilacfork	24	Common Sailer
2	Common Beak	25	Great Hockey Stick
3	Clubbed Beak	26	Powdery Green Sapphire
4	Common Bluebottle	27	Oriental Swift
5	Glassy Bluebottle	28	Yellow Spot Swift
6	Pale Jezebel	29	Common Jester
7	Larger Silverstripe	30	Line Blue
8	Bispot Royal	31	Yellow Sailer
9	Himalayan Five Ring	32	Striped Punch
10	Common Hedge Blue	33	Clouded Yellow
11	Pale Grass Blue	34	Tiger Brown
12	Punchinello	35	Blackvein
13	Chocolate Pansy	36	Common Birdwing
14	Pale Green Sailer	37	Stately Nawab
15	Indian Cabbage White	38	Golden Birdwing
16	Indian Tortoiseshell	39	Bronze Duke
17	Common Peacock	40	Grand Duchess
18	Common Map	41	Pallas Sailer
19	Common Grass Yellow	42	Moore's Five Ring
20	Blue Striped Crow	43	Veined Labyrinth
21	Rose Windmill	44	Margined Hedge Blue
22	Lilacine Bush Brown	45	Common Woodbrown
23	Dark Judy	46	Moore's Bush Brown

